MHT-CET MBA/MMS — DETAILED ENGLISH GRAMMAR MASTER GUIDE

ELI5 + normal English + exam logic + 5+ examples per point + Error Spotting + Choose the Correct Sentence + Figures of Speech

What changed from the previous guide? Every topic is now explained in a normal teaching style: what it means, how to recognise it, how to use it, common mistakes, and examples. This is meant to be studied like a teacher is explaining it—not memorised like a dictionary.

Exam grounding: The supplied MAH-MBA/MMS-CET material contains Verbal Ability questions involving error identification and sentence correction/rephrasing. For example, its sample asks candidates to identify an erroneous part and separately asks them to choose the best rewriting of a sentence. ■filecite■turn1file0■L1-L8■

1. Parts of Speech

In normal English: Think of a sentence as a team. Every word has a job. A noun names something, a pronoun stands in for a noun, a verb tells us what happens or what something is, an adjective describes a noun, and an adverb gives extra information about an action or description. Prepositions show relationships, conjunctions join ideas, and interjections show sudden emotion.

What to remember:

- Noun = naming word.
- Pronoun = replacement word.
- Verb = action/state word.
- Adjective = describes a noun.
- Adverb = describes how/when/where/how much.
- Preposition = relationship word.
- Conjunction = joining word.
- Interjection = sudden feeling word.

Examples:

1. The **student** solved the problem. (noun)
2. **She** solved it. (pronoun)
3. She **solved** it. (verb)
4. It was a **difficult** problem. (adjective)
5. She solved it **quickly**. (adverb)
6. The book is **on** the table. (preposition)
7. Riya **and** Aman studied. (conjunction)
8. **Wow!** That was fast. (interjection)

Common mistake / exam tip: Exam tip: Do not identify a word by memorising its appearance. Identify what job it is doing in that sentence.

2. Articles — A, An, The

In normal English: Articles are tiny words, but they create many entrance-exam errors. **A** and **an** generally introduce one non-specific countable noun. **The** points to a particular or already-known noun. The choice between a and an depends on the **sound** at the beginning, not simply the first letter.

What to remember:

- Use a before a consonant sound: a university, a European.
- Use an before a vowel sound: an hour, an MBA, an honest person.
- Use the when the listener knows which thing you mean.
- Do not automatically put an before every word beginning with a vowel letter.
- General plural/uncountable statements often use no article.

Examples:

1. She is **a** university student.
2. He waited for **an** hour.
3. Please close **the** door beside you.
4. He is **an** honest man.

5. **Books** can change lives.

Common mistake / exam tip: Common trap: **a honest** is wrong because honest begins with a vowel sound; **an university** is wrong because university begins with a /yu■/ consonant sound.

3. Determiners

In normal English: Determiners sit before nouns and give us information about which noun, how many, how much, or whose noun we mean. You can think of them as labels placed before a noun.

What to remember:

- this/that = one nearby/far item
- these/those = plural nearby/far items
- many/few = countable plural nouns
- much/little = uncountable nouns
- each/every = individual members of a group
- some/any = amount/number without exact quantity

Examples:

1. **This** question is easy.
2. There are **many** candidates.
3. We have **little** time.
4. **Each** student received a sheet.
5. Do you have **any** doubts?

Common mistake / exam tip: Common trap: say **many students**, but **much time**. Do not say much students or many time.

4. Nouns

In normal English: A noun is the name of a person, place, object, idea, quality, activity, or group. Some nouns are easy to see—book, college, teacher. Others are ideas—honesty, freedom, success.

What to remember:

- Countable nouns can normally be counted: one book, two books.
- Uncountable nouns are treated as masses/ideas: information, advice, furniture.
- Collective nouns name groups: team, committee, family.
- Possessive nouns show ownership: student's book, students' books.
- Plural nouns normally need correct plural spelling.

Examples:

1. The **teacher** explained the rule.
2. Mumbai is a busy **city**.
3. **Honesty** builds trust.
4. The **team** celebrated.
5. I need some **information**.

Common mistake / exam tip: Common trap: **informations, advices, furnitures** are not standard forms. Say **information, advice, furniture**.

5. Pronouns

In normal English: Pronouns are words that replace nouns so we do not repeat the same name again and again. Instead of saying 'Riya opened Riya's book because Riya needed Riya's notes', we say 'Riya opened her book because she needed her notes.'

What to remember:

- Subject: I, he, she, we, they
- Object: me, him, her, us, them
- Possessive: mine, yours, his, hers, ours, theirs
- Reflexive: myself, yourself, himself, herself, ourselves
- Relative: who, whom, whose, which, that

Examples:

1. **She** completed the work.
2. The teacher praised **him**.
3. This notebook is **mine**.
4. He prepared the presentation **himself**.
5. The student **who** won smiled.

Common mistake / exam tip: Common trap: **Rahul and me went** is wrong in formal grammar; use **Rahul and I went**. But **The teacher called Rahul and me** is correct because it is an object.

6. Adjectives

In normal English: An adjective describes or gives information about a noun or pronoun. Ask 'What kind?', 'Which one?', or 'How many?' to find many adjectives.

What to remember:

- Quality: difficult, beautiful, honest
- Quantity/number: five, several, many
- Demonstrative: this, that, these, those when used before nouns
- Possessive: my, your, their
- Participial adjectives: boring, bored, broken, interested

Examples:

1. She gave a **clear** explanation.
2. They rented a **large** hall.
3. He solved **five** questions.
4. It was an **interesting** lecture.
5. The **broken** chair was replaced.

Common mistake / exam tip: Common trap: **I am boring** means you cause boredom. **I am bored** means you feel boredom.

7. Degrees of Comparison

In normal English: When one thing is described, use the positive form. When two things are compared, use the comparative form. When one is compared with a whole group of three or more, use the superlative form.

What to remember:

- Short adjectives often use -er/-est: tall, taller, tallest.
- Longer adjectives often use more/most: useful, more useful, most useful.

• Irregular: good/better/best; bad/worse/worst.

• Do not use two comparative markers together.

• Use 'than' with a comparative in normal comparisons.

Examples:

1. This book is **useful**.
2. This book is **more useful than** that one.
3. This is the **most useful** book here.
4. Today is **better than** yesterday.
5. That was the **worst** mistake.

Common mistake / exam tip: Common traps: **more better**, **most best**, **more taller**. Use only one comparison structure.

8. Adverbs

In normal English: An adverb gives extra information about a verb, adjective, another adverb, or sometimes the whole sentence. Ask 'How?', 'When?', 'Where?', or 'How often?'.

What to remember:

• How: quickly, carefully, clearly

• When: today, yesterday, soon

• Where: here, outside, everywhere

• Frequency: always, often, rarely, never

• Degree: very, quite, extremely

Examples:

1. She spoke **clearly**.
2. We will leave **tomorrow**.
3. Please wait **outside**.
4. He **often** practises.
5. The question was **very** difficult.

Common mistake / exam tip: Common trap: **She sings beautiful** is wrong in standard grammar; **She sings beautifully** is correct because the word describes how she sings.

9. Verbs

In normal English: A verb is the engine of a sentence. It tells us what happens, what someone does, or what state something is in. A sentence normally needs a verb to express a complete action/state.

What to remember:

• Main verb: study, run, know

• Helping verb: is, are, has, do

• Modal: can, should, must

• Transitive verbs can take an object: open the door.

• Intransitive verbs do not need a direct object: sleep, arrive.

Examples:

1. They **solved** the puzzle.
2. She **knows** the answer.

3. He **is** studying.
4. You **should** revise.
5. The train **arrived**.

Common mistake / exam tip: Common trap: after a modal, use the base verb: **can go**, not can goes; **should study**, not should studied.

10. Tenses — Complete Picture

In normal English: Tense tells us when an action happens and sometimes whether it is ongoing or completed. The easiest way to learn tenses is to attach each form to a timeline.

What to remember:

- Present simple: habit/fact — I study.
- Present continuous: happening now — I am studying.
- Present perfect: past action connected to now — I have studied.
- Past simple: finished past — I studied yesterday.
- Past continuous: action in progress in past — I was studying.
- Past perfect: earlier of two past actions — I had studied before the test.
- Future simple: later action — I will study.
- Future continuous: action in progress later — I will be studying.

Examples:

1. She **studies** every day.
2. She **is studying** now.
3. She **has finished** the chapter.
4. She **studied** yesterday.
5. She **had finished** before dinner.

Common mistake / exam tip: Common trap: words like **yesterday** normally signal simple past. 'Since/for' often require a perfect construction when an action continues to the present.

11. Subject–Verb Agreement

In normal English: The subject is the person/thing doing or being something. The verb must agree with that subject. The biggest exam trap is a plural-looking word sitting near a singular subject.

What to remember:

- Each/every/neither/either normally take singular verbs.
- A phrase between subject and verb does not change the subject.
- Two subjects joined by and usually take a plural verb.
- With either/or and neither/nor, the nearer subject often controls agreement in formal usage.
- News, mathematics and some other nouns can look plural but take singular verbs depending on usage.

Examples:

1. The student **is** ready.
2. The students **are** ready.
3. Each of the players **has** a jersey.
4. The box of books **is** heavy.

5. Riya and Aman **are** ready.

Common mistake / exam tip: Common trap: **The list of topics are** is wrong; the subject is list, so use **is**.

12. Prepositions

In normal English: Prepositions are small words that show relationships. They can tell us where something is, when something happens, or how two ideas are connected.

What to remember:

- Place: in, on, under, beside
- Time: at 6, on Monday, in June
- Direction: to, towards, into, through
- Common combinations must often be memorised.
- Preposition + gerund is common: interested in learning.

Examples:

1. The keys are **on** the table.
2. Class starts **at** 9.
3. She walked **towards** the gate.
4. He is interested **in** finance.
5. Success depends **on** practice.

Common mistake / exam tip: Common traps: good **at**, interested **in**, capable **of**, responsible **for**, depend **on**.

13. Conjunctions

In normal English: Conjunctions connect ideas. They help us show addition, contrast, choice, reason, condition, time, and more.

What to remember:

- and = addition
- but/yet = contrast
- or = choice
- because = reason
- although = contrast despite a condition
- either...or / neither...nor / not only...but also = paired conjunctions

Examples:

1. Riya **and** Aman prepared.
2. He was tired, **but** he continued.
3. Study now **or** revise later.
4. She stayed home **because** it rained.
5. **Although** it was late, they continued.

Common mistake / exam tip: Common trap: avoid incorrect pairs such as **although...but** in standard exam constructions.

14. Phrases and Clauses

In normal English: A phrase is a group of words that does not contain a complete subject-and-verb idea. A clause contains a subject and a verb. An independent clause can stand alone; a dependent clause needs another clause.

What to remember:

- Noun phrase: the new student
- Prepositional phrase: in the classroom
- Independent clause: She smiled.
- Dependent clause: because she was happy
- Relative clause: who won the prize

Examples:

1. The girl **in the blue dress** smiled.
2. **She smiled.**
3. **Because she was happy**, she smiled.
4. The book **that you gave me** is useful.
5. We left **when the rain stopped**.

Common mistake / exam tip: Exam use: recognising clauses helps you detect sentence fragments, comma-related structure errors and incorrect sentence combinations.

15. Modals

In normal English: Modals show ability, possibility, permission, advice, obligation or prediction. They are followed by the base form of the verb.

What to remember:

- can/could = ability or possibility
- may/might = permission or possibility
- should/ought to = advice
- must/have to = necessity
- would = conditional/polite/request contexts

Examples:

1. She **can solve** it.
2. You **should revise**.
3. You **may leave**.
4. Candidates **must carry** ID.
5. It **might rain**.

Common mistake / exam tip: Common trap: **He can goes** is wrong. Say **He can go**.

16. Conditionals

In normal English: Conditionals are 'if' situations. The tense pattern tells us whether we are talking about a general truth, a realistic future possibility, an unlikely situation, or an unreal past situation.

What to remember:

- Zero: If + present, present.
- First: If + present, will + base.
- Second: If + past, would + base.
- Third: If + had + V3, would have + V3.
- Do not normally put 'will' immediately after if in the basic first conditional.

Examples:

1. If you heat ice, it **melts**.
2. If she studies, she **will improve**.
3. If I had time, I **would practise**.
4. If he had prepared, he **would have succeeded**.
5. If I were you, I **would revise**.

Common mistake / exam tip: Common trap: **If she will study, she will pass** is normally wrong for the standard first conditional; use **If she studies, she will pass**.

17. Active and Passive Voice

In normal English: In active voice, the subject does the action. In passive voice, the receiver of the action becomes the focus. The passive normally uses a form of 'be' plus the past participle.

What to remember:

- Present: is/am/are + V3
- Past: was/were + V3
- Future: will be + V3
- Modal: must/can/should be + V3
- Only transitive verbs normally form a normal passive with a direct object.

Examples:

1. They **solve** the problem → The problem **is solved**.
2. She **wrote** the letter → The letter **was written**.
3. They **will announce** the result → It **will be announced**.
4. You **must complete** the form → It **must be completed**.
5. Someone stole the phone → The phone **was stolen**.

Common mistake / exam tip: Common trap: do not change the tense while changing voice.

18. Direct and Indirect Speech

In normal English: Direct speech repeats the speaker's exact words. Indirect speech reports the meaning. When reporting past speech, tenses often move one step back, but not every situation requires mechanical backshift.

What to remember:

- Statement: said that...
- Yes/no question: asked whether/if...
- Wh-question: asked + wh-word + statement order
- Command: told/ordered + object + to + verb
- Request: asked + object + to + verb

Examples:

1. “I am ready.” → She said she **was ready**.
2. “I finished.” → He said he **had finished**.
3. “Are you ready?” → He asked **whether I was ready**.
4. “Where do you live?” → She asked **where I lived**.
5. “Open the door.” → He **ordered me to open** it.

Common mistake / exam tip: Common trap: indirect questions use statement word order: 'He asked where I lived', not 'where did I live'.

19. Gerunds

In normal English: A gerund is an -ing form that behaves like a noun. It can be the subject or object of a sentence and commonly follows certain verbs and prepositions.

What to remember:

- After enjoy: enjoy reading
- After avoid: avoid making
- After finish: finish studying
- After preposition: interested in learning
- As subject: Reading helps.

Examples:

1. **Reading** improves vocabulary.
2. She enjoys **reading**.
3. They avoided **arguing**.
4. He is interested in **learning**.
5. **Practising** daily improves speed.

Common mistake / exam tip: Common trap: **enjoy to read** is normally wrong; use **enjoy reading**.

20. Infinitives

In normal English: The full infinitive is usually 'to + base verb'. It can express purpose, intention, a noun-like idea, or describe a noun. Some structures use a bare infinitive without 'to'.

What to remember:

- Purpose: to improve
- After want/decide/hope/plan: to study
- After certain verbs such as let/make: bare infinitive
- After modal verbs: bare infinitive
- Adjective-like: a book to read

Examples:

1. She studied **to improve**.
2. He decided **to practise**.
3. **To learn** takes patience.
4. Let him **go**.
5. I have a book **to read**.

Common mistake / exam tip: Common trap: **He made me to go** is wrong in standard usage; say **He made me go**.

21. Participles

In normal English: Participles are verb forms used inside verb phrases or as adjectives. Present participles often end in -ing; past participles are commonly V3 forms.

What to remember:

- Present participle: running water
- Past participle: broken glass
- Perfect participle: having finished
- Continuous verb: is studying
- Passive verb: was written

Examples:

1. The **shining** stars looked beautiful.
2. The **broken** window was repaired.
3. **Having finished** the work, she left.
4. They are **preparing**.
5. The answer was **written** carefully.

Common mistake / exam tip: Common trap: avoid dangling modifiers. In 'Walking to college, the rain started', the rain appears to be walking.

22. Question Tags

In normal English: A question tag is a short question added to the end of a statement. A positive statement normally takes a negative tag; a negative statement takes a positive tag.

What to remember:

- Use the same auxiliary/modal.
- Use a matching pronoun.
- If there is no auxiliary in simple present/past, use do/does/did.
- Special cases such as 'Let's...' and imperatives have their own common patterns.
- Intonation can change whether it is a real question, but the grammar pattern remains.

Examples:

1. She is ready, **isn't she?**
2. He isn't late, **is he?**
3. You can swim, **can't you?**
4. They finished, **didn't they?**
5. Open the window, **will you?**

Common mistake / exam tip: Common trap: **She likes tea, isn't she?** is wrong; use **doesn't she?** because the main verb is likes.

23. Parallelism

In normal English: Parallelism means that items in the same grammatical list should have the same shape. It makes sentences balanced and is a favourite source of correction questions.

What to remember:

- gerund + gerund + gerund
- to-infinitive + to-infinitive + to-infinitive
- noun + noun + noun
- adjective + adjective + adjective
- Keep paired conjunction structures balanced.

Examples:

1. She likes **reading, writing and travelling**.
2. He wants **to learn, to practise and to improve**.
3. She is **smart, disciplined and patient**.
4. The job requires **skill, patience and focus**.
5. It is **not only difficult but also time-consuming**.

Common mistake / exam tip: Common trap: **reading, writing and to travel** mixes forms. Use **reading, writing and travelling**.

24. Commonly Confused Words

In normal English: These words cause errors because they look or sound similar. Learn their meaning and use them in sentences rather than memorising spelling alone.

What to remember:

• its = possession; it's = it is/it has

• their = possession; there = place; they're = they are

• your = possession; you're = you are

• affect = usually verb; effect = usually noun

• principal = head/person or main; principle = rule/belief

Examples:

1. **It's** raining; the company changed **its** policy.
2. **They're** waiting **there** with **their** books.
3. **You're** responsible for **your** work.
4. Sleep can **affect** focus; the **effect** was clear.
5. The **principal** explained the school's **principle**.

Common mistake / exam tip: Exam tip: expand contractions. If 'it's' means 'it is', it is correct; if you need possession, use 'its'.

25. ERROR SPOTTING — HOW TO SOLVE IT

ELI5: You are given a sentence split into parts. One part may contain a grammar error. Your job is not to rewrite the whole sentence immediately. First locate the broken rule.

Use this checking order: 1) subject + verb, 2) pronoun, 3) article/determiner, 4) tense, 5) preposition, 6) adjective/adverb, 7) comparison, 8) parallelism, 9) word meaning.

Example 1: Each of the students / have submitted / their assignment / on time.

Explanation: Part 2: **have** → **has**. 'Each' is singular.

Example 2: The list of topics / are / on the desk / near the window.

Explanation: Part 2: **are** → **is**. The subject is 'list'.

Example 3: She / is one of the best student / in the class / this year.

Explanation: Part 2: **student** → **students**. One of the + plural noun.

Example 4: The teacher asked / Rahul and I / to wait / outside.

Explanation: Part 2: **I** → **me**. The pronoun is an object of 'asked'.

Example 5: She completed the assignment / quick / and submitted it / before lunch.

Explanation: Part 2: **quick** → **quickly**. It modifies 'completed'.

Example 6: He is good / in mathematics / but weak / in English.

Explanation: Part 2: **in** → **at**. Standard combination is good at.

Example 7: He has completed / the work / yesterday / without help.

Explanation: Part 3 creates a tense mismatch. Use simple past: 'He completed the work yesterday.'

Example 8: The students / was waiting / outside the hall / for an hour.

Explanation: Part 2: **was** → **were**. Students is plural.

Source connection: The supplied MAH-MBA/MMS-CET material uses exactly this kind of four-part sentence and asks candidates to identify the erroneous part or choose 'No error'. ■filecite■turn1file0■L1-L8■

26. CHOOSE THE CORRECT SENTENCE / SENTENCE IMPROVEMENT

ELI5: Here the sentence may already look almost correct. Several options give different versions. Your job is to choose the version that follows standard grammar and gives the clearest meaning.

Step-by-step: First understand the meaning. Then compare the subject and verb. Then check tense, pronouns, articles, prepositions, word order and unnecessary words.

Example 1

A) She is a honest student.
B) She is an honest student.
C) She is honest a student.
D) She is an honesty student.

Why: B. Honest begins with a vowel sound, so use an.

Example 2

A) Neither of the boys are ready.
B) Neither of the boys is ready.
C) Neither boys is ready.
D) Neither of boys are ready.

Why: B. Neither is singular in this construction.

Example 3

A) He has went home.
B) He has gone home.
C) He had go home.
D) He has going home.

Why: B. Has + past participle; gone is V3.

Example 4

A) I prefer tea than coffee.
B) I prefer tea to coffee.
C) I prefer tea from coffee.
D) I prefer tea over than coffee.

Why: B. The standard construction is prefer X to Y.

Example 5

A) The news are surprising.
B) The news is surprising.
C) The news were surprising.
D) The news have surprising.

Why: B. News is normally treated as singular.

Example 6

A) She is capable to solve it.
B) She is capable of solving it.
C) She is capable for solve it.
D) She is capable solving it.

Why: B. Capable of + gerund.

Example 7

A) One of my friend is preparing.
B) One of my friends is preparing.
C) One of my friends are preparing.
D) One of my friend are preparing.

Why: B. One of + plural noun, followed by singular verb.

Example 8

A) She suggested me to study.

B) She suggested that I study.

C) She suggested me studying.

D) She suggested to me study.

Why: B is the standard formal construction.

27. FIGURES OF SPEECH — EXPLAINED LIKE A TEACHER

Important: There is no single universally agreed finite list called 'all figures of speech'. Different textbooks group or name them differently. The list below is a broad exam-relevant set. Learn the clue and the difference between similar figures.

Simile

Normal explanation: A direct comparison using words such as like or as.

1. Her smile was **like sunshine**.
2. He slept **like a log**.
3. She ran **as fast as the wind**.
4. The room was **like an oven**.
5. Her voice was **as soft as silk**.

How to spot it: Clue: explicit comparison using like/as.

Metaphor

Normal explanation: A direct comparison in which one thing is described as another thing, without like/as.

1. Time is **a thief**.
2. Her voice **was music**.
3. The city **is a jungle**.
4. His words **were arrows**.
5. Knowledge **is power**.

How to spot it: Clue: direct comparison.

Personification

Normal explanation: A non-human thing is given a human action, feeling or quality.

1. The wind **whispered**.
2. The alarm clock **screamed**.
3. The moon **watched** us.
4. Opportunity **knocked**.
5. The old house **groaned**.

How to spot it: Clue: non-human thing behaves like a person.

Hyperbole

Normal explanation: Deliberate exaggeration used for emphasis, not literal truth.

1. I told you **a million times**.
2. This bag weighs **a ton**.
3. She waited **forever**.
4. He was **dying of embarrassment**.
5. That was **the hardest exam on Earth**.

How to spot it: Clue: impossible/obviously exaggerated.

Alliteration

Normal explanation: Repetition of the same or similar initial consonant sound in nearby words.

1. **Wild winds whistle**.

2. **Peter picked purple plums**.
3. **Busy bees buzzed**.
4. **Silver snakes slid**.
5. **Bright blue balloons** floated.

How to spot it: Clue: repeated starting consonant sound.

Assonance

Normal explanation: Repetition of vowel sounds in nearby words.

1. The **light** of the **fire** shone bright.
2. The **cool moon** moved slowly.
3. He **tried to hide** the sign.
4. The **rainy day** faded away.
5. The **mellow wedding bells** rang.

How to spot it: Clue: repeated vowel sound.

Consonance

Normal explanation: Repetition of consonant sounds, often inside or at the end of words.

1. The **stroke of luck** helped.
2. The **lumpy, bumpy** road shook.
3. The wind **bent the tent**.
4. The **crisp clasp** snapped.
5. The **blank and think** pattern repeats a consonant sound.

How to spot it: Clue: consonant sound repetition; not necessarily at the start.

Onomatopoeia

Normal explanation: A word imitates or strongly suggests the sound it describes.

1. The door went **bang**.
2. The bees **buzzed**.
3. The clock went **tick-tock**.
4. Water **sizzled**.
5. The snake **hissed**.

How to spot it: Clue: the word sounds like the sound.

Oxymoron

Normal explanation: Two apparently contradictory words are placed together as a short expression.

1. **deafening silence**
2. **bittersweet** memory
3. **jumbo shrimp**
4. **living dead**
5. **seriously funny**

How to spot it: Clue: contradiction packed into a phrase.

Paradox

Normal explanation: A whole statement appears contradictory but can express a meaningful truth.

1. **Less is more.**
2. **The more you learn, the less you know.**
3. **The only constant is change.**
4. **To save money, you sometimes spend money.**
5. **Freedom requires rules.**

How to spot it: Clue: contradiction at the level of a complete idea.

Irony

Normal explanation: There is a meaningful contrast between expectation and reality, or between literal wording and intended meaning.

1. A fire station burns down.
2. A traffic officer gets a speeding ticket.
3. A dentist has terrible teeth.
4. A weather expert forgets an umbrella in rain.
5. After disaster: **What a perfect result.**

How to spot it: Clue: what happens/means contrasts with what is expected.

Sarcasm

Normal explanation: A sharp, mocking form of irony, usually used to criticise or tease.

1. After a huge mistake: **Brilliant job!**
2. To someone very late: **Nice of you to join us.**
3. During heavy rain: **Perfect beach weather.**
4. After breaking the printer: **Exactly what we needed.**
5. Seeing a messy desk: **Beautiful organisation.**

How to spot it: Clue: mocking tone; sarcasm is a type/style of ironic expression.

Euphemism

Normal explanation: A softer or less direct expression for something unpleasant, sensitive or harsh.

1. **passed away** = died
2. **let go** = fired
3. **between jobs** = unemployed
4. **economical with the truth** = not telling the truth
5. **senior citizen** = elderly person

How to spot it: Clue: soften the expression.

Litotes

Normal explanation: A form of understatement that often uses a negative to express a positive or strong idea.

1. It is **not bad**.
2. She is **not unfamiliar** with it.
3. That was **no small achievement**.
4. He is **not unintelligent**.
5. The result is **not insignificant**.

How to spot it: Clue: negative wording creates an understated positive.

Antithesis

Normal explanation: Two contrasting ideas are placed in balanced grammatical structure.

1. **Speech is silver; silence is golden.**
2. **Many are called, few are chosen.**
3. **Easy to begin, hard to finish.**
4. **Hope for the best, prepare for the worst.**
5. **Small step, giant leap.**

How to spot it: Clue: balanced contrast.

Anaphora

Normal explanation: A word or phrase is repeated at the beginning of successive clauses or sentences.

1. **We will** learn. **We will** practise.
2. **Every day** she reads; **every day** she writes.
3. **This is** our time; **this is** our chance.
4. **I want** focus; **I want** discipline.
5. **Never** give up; **never** stop learning.

How to spot it: Clue: repetition at the beginning.

Epistrophe

Normal explanation: A word or phrase is repeated at the end of successive clauses or sentences.

1. We work for **success**, study for **success**.
2. They asked for **justice**, fought for **justice**.
3. She wanted to **learn**, lived to **learn**.
4. We prepare for **today**, work for **today**.
5. He spoke with **courage**, acted with **courage**.

How to spot it: Clue: repetition at the end.

Climax

Normal explanation: Ideas or events are arranged so that intensity rises.

1. He whispered, spoke, shouted.
2. She learned, practised, mastered.
3. He risked time, money, reputation.
4. The problem became difficult, serious, disastrous.
5. A spark became a flame, then a wildfire.

How to spot it: Clue: rising intensity.

Anticlimax

Normal explanation: A build-up suddenly ends in something much less important or impressive.

1. He trained for months and forgot his shoes.
2. She expected a grand surprise and received a pen.
3. The speech promised revolution and ended with a coupon.

4. He solved the crisis and lost his lunch.
5. They planned an epic trip and stayed in the lobby.

How to spot it: Clue: sudden fall after build-up.

Pun

Normal explanation: Wordplay using different meanings or similar sounds.

1. A bicycle cannot stand because it is **two-tired**.
2. The calendar's days are **numbered**.
3. A boiled egg is **hard to beat**.
4. The banker **lost interest**.
5. The math teacher has too many **problems**.

How to spot it: Clue: deliberate wordplay.

Allusion

Normal explanation: An indirect reference to a famous person, event, place, book, myth or story.

1. He met his **Waterloo**.
2. She is a **Romeo**.
3. It became our **Trojan horse**.
4. He has the patience of **Job**.
5. She opened a **Pandora's box**.

How to spot it: Clue: reference without explaining the whole story.

Apostrophe

Normal explanation: The speaker directly addresses an absent person, object, dead person or abstract idea.

1. **O Time**, slow down!
2. **Dear Moon**, light my path.
3. **O Justice**, where are you?
4. **Death**, do not take him yet.
5. **Freedom**, we value you.

How to spot it: Clue: direct address to something not literally participating.

Metonymy

Normal explanation: One thing is replaced by a closely associated thing.

1. The **crown** announced a decision.
2. The **White House** issued a statement.
3. The **press** asked questions.
4. The **bench** delivered its ruling.
5. The **stage** applauded her work.

How to spot it: Clue: association, not similarity.

Synecdoche

Normal explanation: A part represents the whole, or the whole represents a part.

1. All **hands** on deck.

2. More **boots** on the ground.
3. Nice **wheels**.
4. Many new **faces** arrived.
5. We need more **hands** for the project.

How to spot it: Clue: part–whole relationship.

Transferred Epithet

Normal explanation: An adjective is attached to a noun that does not logically experience the quality; the quality belongs to another person/thing.

1. A **sleepless night**.
2. The **angry streets** were crowded.
3. A **restless journey**.
4. A **miserable holiday**.
5. A **thoughtful look**.

How to spot it: Clue: the adjective seems transferred from the real experiencer.

Rhetorical Question

Normal explanation: A question is asked for effect rather than to obtain an actual answer.

1. **Who doesn't want success?**
2. **How could I forget you?**
3. **Isn't this amazing?**
4. **What is more important than time?**
5. **Do we really need another excuse?**

How to spot it: Clue: the expected answer is obvious or unnecessary.

Inversion

Normal explanation: Normal word order is deliberately changed for emphasis or style.

1. **Never have I seen** such a view.
2. **Rarely does she complain.**
3. **Down came the rain.**
4. **Only then did he understand.**
5. **So difficult was the test** that many struggled.

How to spot it: Clue: unusual/reversed word order.

Pleonasm

Normal explanation: Extra words repeat or add little to the meaning; often used for emphasis.

1. **free gift**
2. **final conclusion**
3. **past history**
4. **advance planning**
5. **new innovation**

How to spot it: Clue: unnecessary repetition of meaning.

Tautology

Normal explanation: The same idea is repeated using different words; some expressions are conventional and can be stylistic.

1. **each and every**
2. **null and void**
3. **first and foremost**
4. **safe and sound**
5. **true fact**

How to spot it: Clue: repeated meaning.

Pathetic Fallacy

Normal explanation: Nature is described with human emotion or intention, often matching the mood of the scene.

1. The **angry storm** raged.
2. The **cheerful sun** welcomed morning.
3. The **gloomy clouds** followed his sadness.
4. The **jealous sea** swallowed the boat.
5. The **lonely wind** cried at night.

How to spot it: Clue: nature appears to feel like a human.

Paronomasia

Normal explanation: A technical term for wordplay based strongly on similar sounds or related forms; it overlaps with pun.

1. The musician got into **treble**.
2. The gardener's work is **growing** on him.
3. The electrician had a **shocking** career.
4. The fisherman was **hooked** on the idea.
5. The sole survivor had a **sole** story.

How to spot it: Clue: sound/word-form similarity creates the joke or effect.

FINAL STUDY PLAN — HOW SHE SHOULD LEARN THIS

Don't try to memorise the entire book in one day. For each topic, follow four steps: (1) read the ELI5 explanation, (2) read the normal rule, (3) cover the examples and create your own examples, (4) solve 10–20 MCQs on that topic.

Recommended order: Articles → Nouns → Pronouns → Adjectives → Adverbs → Verbs → Tenses → Subject–Verb Agreement → Prepositions → Conjunctions → Clauses → Modals → Conditionals → Voice → Narration → Gerunds/Infinitives → Participles → Parallelism → Error Spotting → Correct Sentence → Figures of Speech.

For every error she makes: don't only write the correct option. Write the rule that caused the mistake. Example: 'Q14 wrong → subject is Each → singular verb → has, not have.' This creates an error log that will improve her score much faster than simply repeating mocks.

Mock progression: topic test first → 25-question grammar test → 50-question mixed grammar test → timed Verbal Ability sets → full MAH-MBA/MMS-CET mock. The supplied CET material shows that Verbal Ability includes more than grammar, so eventually combine grammar with vocabulary and reading comprehension.